Motivation & Recognition

Find out what motivates each person, test how a change will affect it, and thank people specifically and often.

Lead the Organisation · Inspired by Management 3.0 (Jurgen Appelo) · Moving Motivators & Kudo Cards

WORKED EXAMPLE · FICTIONAL TEAM

NAME Jo

DATE 12 May

1 The Ten Motivators

WRITE EACH ON A CARD OR STICKY

Curiosity Plenty to explore and learn	**Honour** My work fits my values	**Acceptance** People approve of me and what I do	**Mastery** Work that stretches my skills	**Power** I can influence what happens
Freedom Independence in my own work	**Relatedness** Good relationships at work	**Order** Enough structure and stability	**Goal** My work serves a purpose I care about	**Status** My position is recognised

2 Rank Them, Then Test a Change

LEFT TO RIGHT · THEN MOVE UP OR DOWN

The change we're testing: *learning payments by pairing with Sam for the next three months*

MORE MOTIVATED ↑

Status	Power		Honour	Acceptance		Goal				
		Order			Freedom					

LESS MOTIVATED ↓

LEAST IMPORTANT TO ME → MOST IMPORTANT TO ME

3 What I Learned

SHARE WHAT YOU CHOOSE

What surprised me: *status matters least; mastery most*

What I need more of: *hard problems with someone to learn from*

What I'll ask for: *keep some solo front-end work*

What I can offer others: *accessibility pairing*

4 Kudo Cards

SPECIFIC · TIMELY · OFTEN

☑ Thank you ☐ Well done ☐ You helped me	☐ Thank you ☐ Well done ☑ You helped me	☐ Thank you ☑ Well done ☐ You helped me
To: Alex	To: Sam	To: Store Ops pickers
For: finding the price bug before the promo went live	For: patient pairing on payments code all week	For: great feedback on the substitute screen
From: Priya	From: Jo	From: Mei

"Which motivator would this change put at risk, and for whom?"

"Who deserves a thank-you this week, and for what exactly?"

© 2026 Eric Parker · CC BY 4.0 · eparker71.github.io/better-delivery-toolkit